ManaLab Guide

What each part of the app does and how to use it. Focus on the main features and the AI coach.

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What ManaLab is

ManaLab saves every match you play in MTG Arena on your PC and shows what works: your win rates by deck, by opponent and by matchup, your mulligans, your mistakes and your sideboard changes.

The app is free. The only paid part is the AI loss analysis: 5 € per month.

First steps

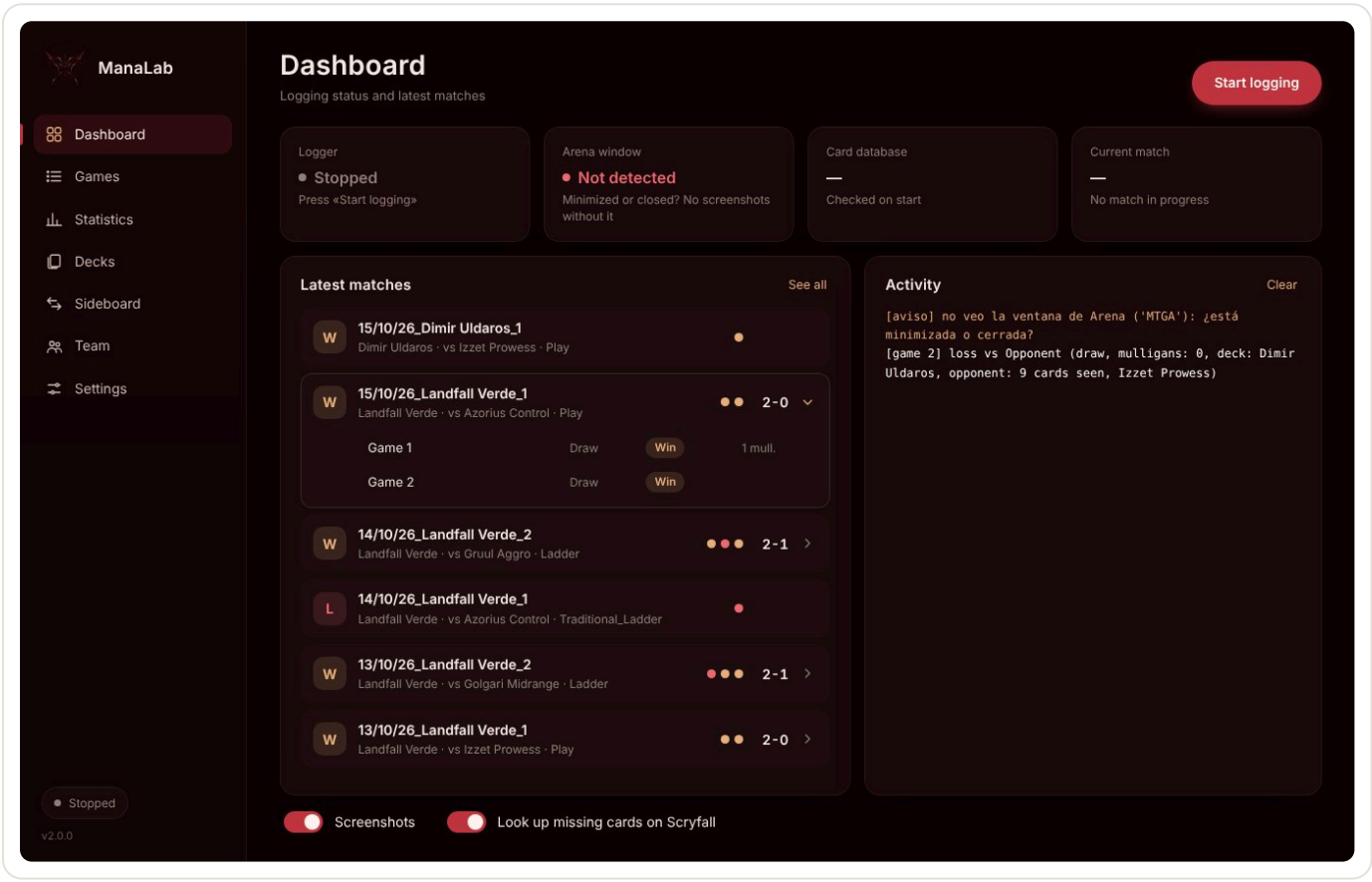
1. Download the portable version (ZIP), extract it and open ManaLab. No installation needed.
2. In Arena, go to Options › Account and turn on «Detailed Logs (Plugin Support)». Then restart Arena. Without this ManaLab cannot read your matches.
3. The first time, the start guide opens. You can open it again from Settings › About.
4. On the Dashboard, press «Start logging». From then on every match is saved automatically.

Dashboard: logging status

The Dashboard tells you whether ManaLab is logging correctly. It has four cards:

- Logger: whether it is running or stopped.
- Arena window: whether ManaLab can see the Arena window (needed for screenshots).
- Card database: whether the card data is up to date.
- Current match: the match being played now.

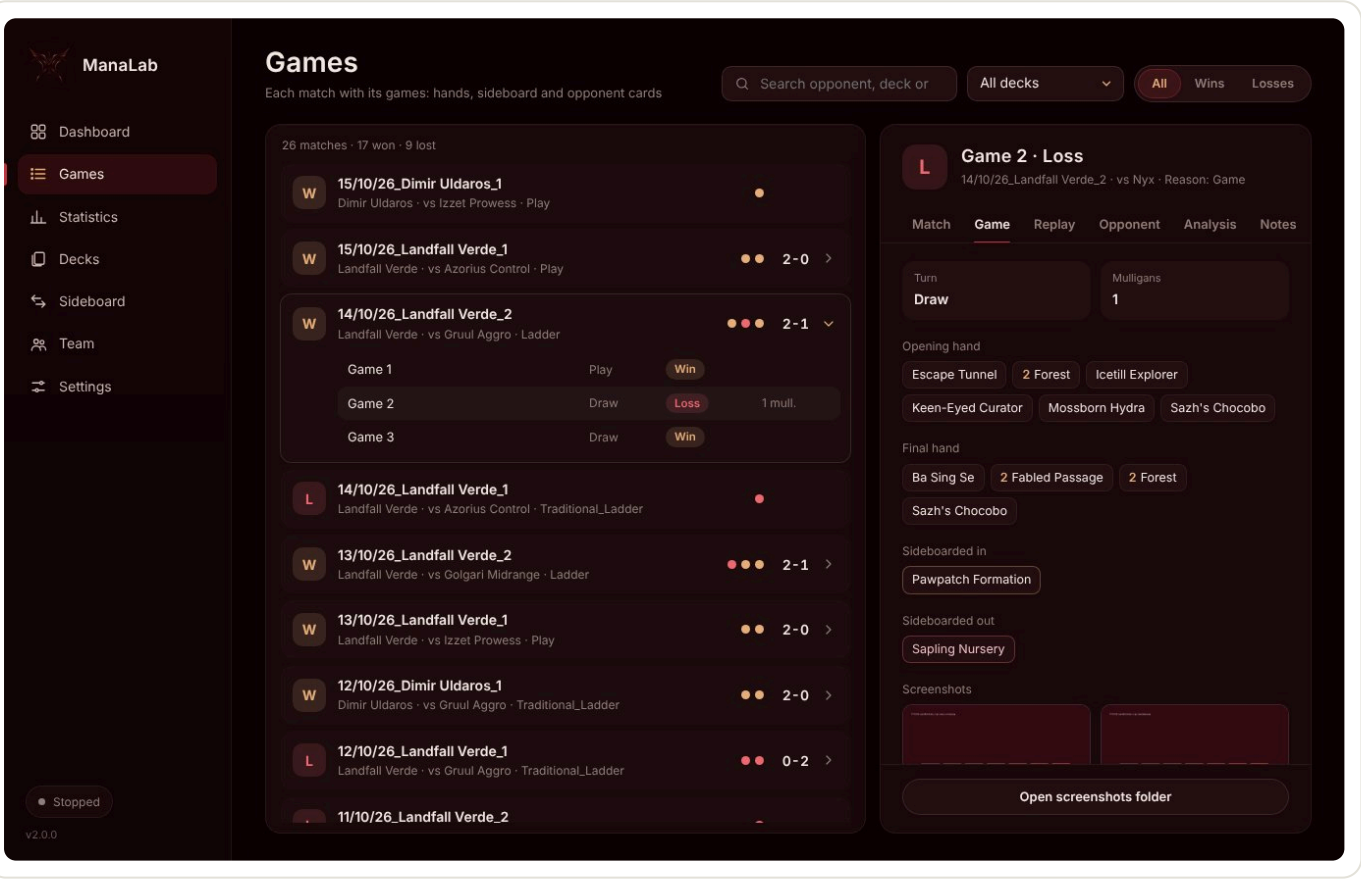
Below you see your latest matches and recent activity.

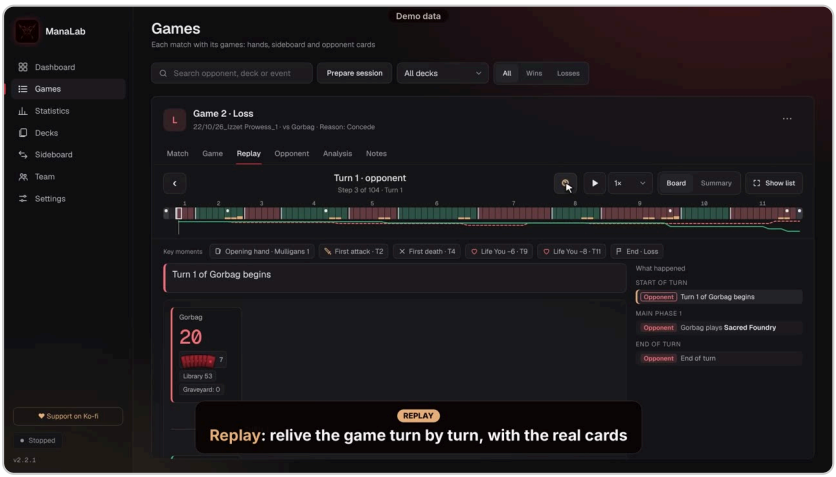


Matches: your history

This is your full match history. Search by opponent, deck or event, and filter by All, Wins or Losses. When you open a match you get these tabs:

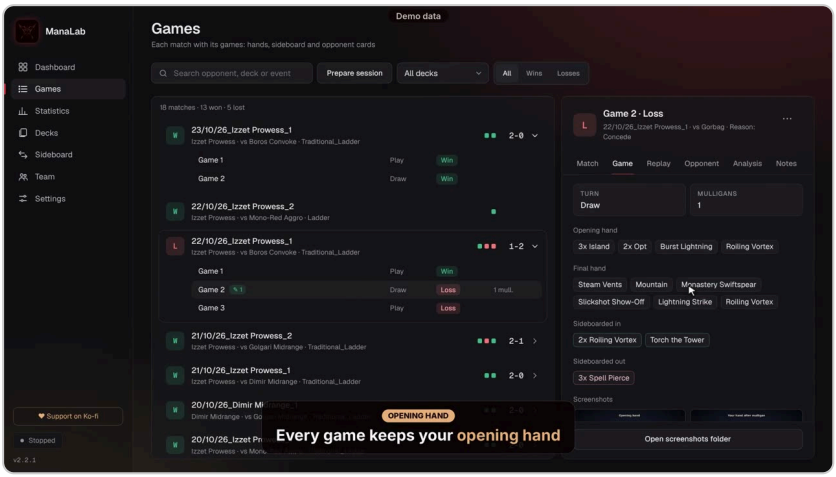
- Match: the match summary and its games.
- Game: opening hand, turn you started on, mulligans and what happened.
- Replay: the game step by step, turn by turn.
- Opponent: the opponent cards you have seen.
- Analysis: the AI explanation (subscribers only).
- Notes: your mistakes and your notes.





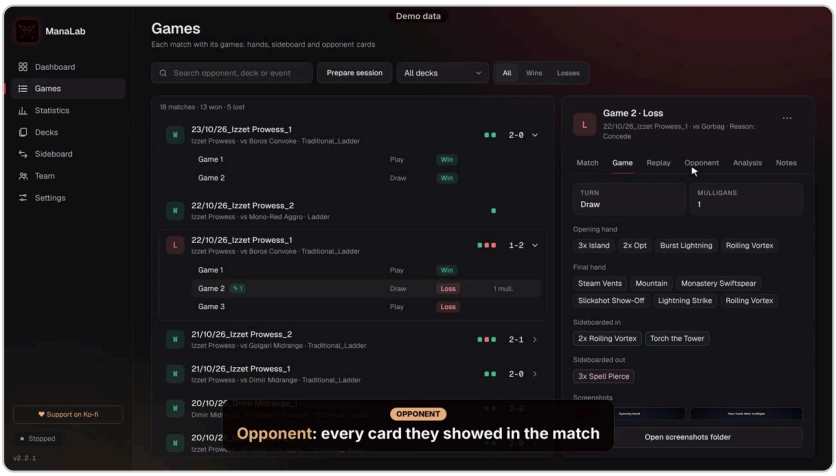
Replay: the game turn by turn, with the real cards and jumps to the key moments. Silent video

Video on the web: https://manalab.es/guia/guia_manalab_en.html#video-replay



Every game keeps your opening hand, the hand you keep after a mulligan and your sideboarding, plus mulligan stats. Silent video

Video on the web: https://manalab.es/guia/guia_manalab_en.html#video-opening-hand-mulligans



Opponent: the cards they showed, their detected archetype and your win rate against each deck. Silent video

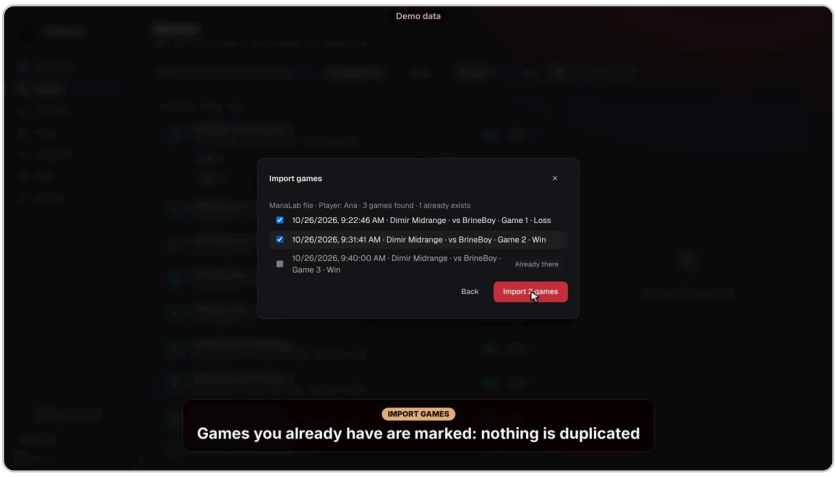
Video on the web: https://manalab.es/guia/guia_manalab_en.html#video-opponent

Importing games

In Matches, «Import...» brings in games from two places: a .manalab file someone sends you (created by «Export game» in the «...» menu of each game) or an Arena Player.log with games you played while ManaLab was closed or on another PC.

You choose which games to import, and the ones you already have are marked, so nothing is duplicated. Imported games have replay, hands, mulligans, deck, notes and coach tags, but no screenshots or AI analysis.

Another player's games carry their mark and never count in your statistics, trends, reports or team. Games you import from your own log do count as yours.



Import games: from a teammate's file or an old log. Games you already have are marked, and another player's games don't count in your statistics. Silent video

Video on the web: https://manalab.es/guia/guia_manalab_en.html#video-import-games

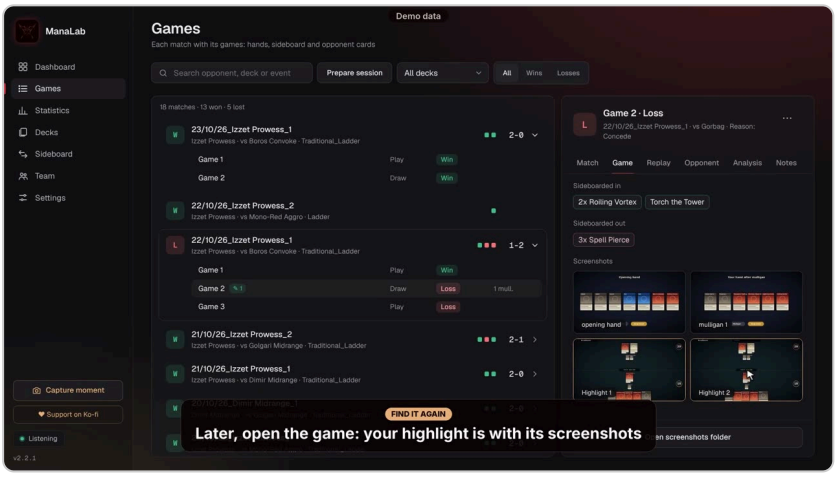
Highlights

During a game you can save a screenshot of any moment you want. It works even if automatic screenshots are turned off.

1. Press F8 (you can change the key in Settings › Highlights).
2. Or press the «Capture moment» button at the top left of Arena.
3. Or press «Capture moment» in ManaLab's sidebar.

The buttons only appear while a game is in progress. The screenshot is saved with the opening hand and mulligans.

Afterwards, in the Game tab, open the screenshot and write a note about that moment.



F8 while you play: a screenshot of that moment is saved, and you find it later in the game with your notes. Silent video

Video on the web: https://manalab.es/guia/guia_manalab_en.html#video-capture-moment

Notes and mistakes

In the Notes tab of each game you can mark the mistakes you made (with tags) and write anything you want to remember. These mistakes feed the report you can send to your coach and the repeated-mistake statistics.

Decks

This page lists the decks ManaLab has detected. From here you can:

- Rename a deck, or use the name it has in Arena.
- Fix the archetype if ManaLab classified it wrong, and reclassify matches.
- Check how your deck fits in the meta.

Statistics: your win rates

Your results organised by:

- Deck.
- Opponent.
- Mulligans.
- Play / draw.
- Recent days.

The matchup table shows which decks you win with and which you lose with. From here you can also export your data for your coach.





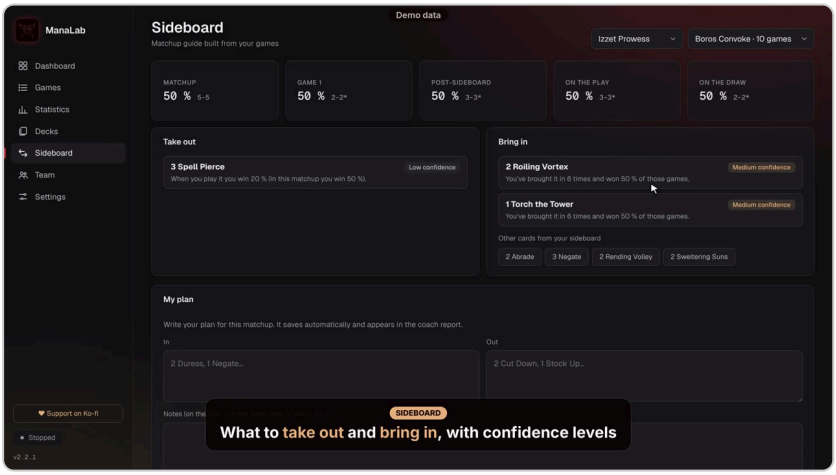
Statistics: win rate, streaks and results by day, by mulligans, by deck, by opponent and by matchup. Silent video

Video on the web: https://manalab.es/guia/guia_manalab_en.html#video-statistics

Sideboard: your plan per matchup

For each matchup you can note what you bring in (In) and what you take out (Out), and write your plan (My plan). ManaLab also shows how your previous changes went.

With a subscription, «Ask the AI for a plan» suggests a sideboard plan based on your games in that matchup.



Sideboard: what to take out and bring in based on your own games, with confidence levels, and your written plan. Silent video

Video on the web: https://manalab.es/guia/guia_manalab_en.html#video-sideboard-guide

AI coach: loss analysis

The AI coach explains what went wrong in a loss and what to try next time. It is for subscribers only: 5 € per month.

1. Subscribe on Ko-fi (the «Subscribe on Ko-fi» button in Settings or in the Analysis tab) or choose a Patreon tier of $5 or more (Researcher or Lab Partner) at patreon.com/ManaLab. In both cases you will receive a code by email.
2. Go to Settings › AI analysis, paste the code into «Subscription code» and save.
3. Open a loss in Matches and go to the Analysis tab.
4. If you want, write a specific question, for example: «Should I have mulliganed?» or «Did I attack badly on turn 5?».
5. Press «Analyse with AI». It takes a few seconds. The answer is saved, so you never pay twice for the same game.

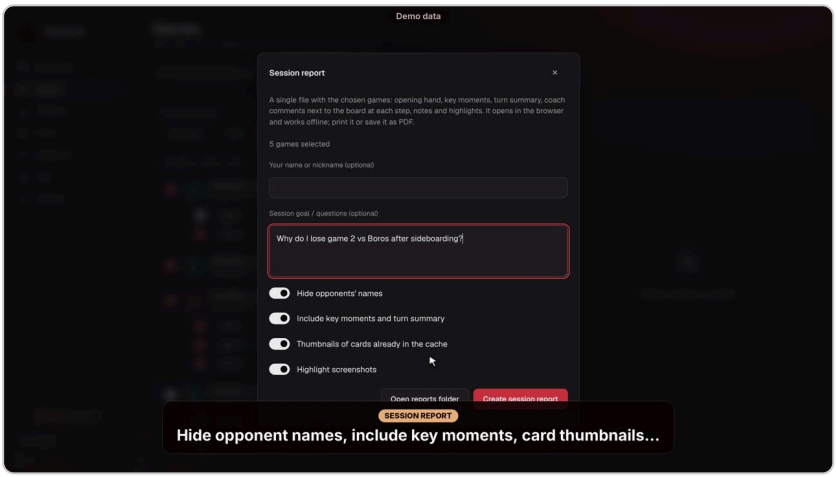
Each code has a daily limit (30 analyses per day by default). The tab shows how many you have left.

Only the data of the game you analyse is sent: deck, hands, sideboard, opponent cards seen and the game timeline. Your name, your opponent's name and the full log file are not sent.

Export for your coach and Team

«Export for coach» (in Statistics) creates a page with your summary, your matchups, your marked mistakes and your games with their notes. It opens in your browser: from there you can print it or save it as PDF and send it to your coach.

In Matches, «Prepare session» lets you pick the games you want to review and creates a single report with your hands, mulligans, key moments, turn summary, notes and highlights. You can hide your opponents' names. It opens in your browser and works offline: print it or save it as PDF.



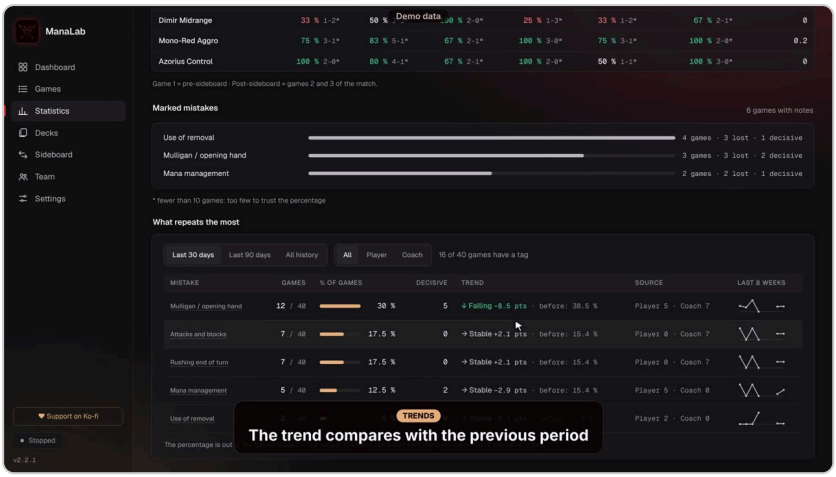
Prepare session: you pick the games and ManaLab builds a single report for your coach.

Silent video

Video on the web: https://manalab.es/guia/guia_manalab_en.html#video-prepare-session

In Team you can share games and notes with your team through a shared folder (Google Drive, Dropbox or OneDrive). Each person writes only in their own subfolder. Screenshots are shared too, with their notes (you can turn this off in Settings › Team), and you can hide your opponents' names.

On the Team screen, each teammate's game shows the same detail as yours: hands, screenshots with their notes, replay, opponent's deck and notes. If you're a coach, you write your note in the Notes tab.

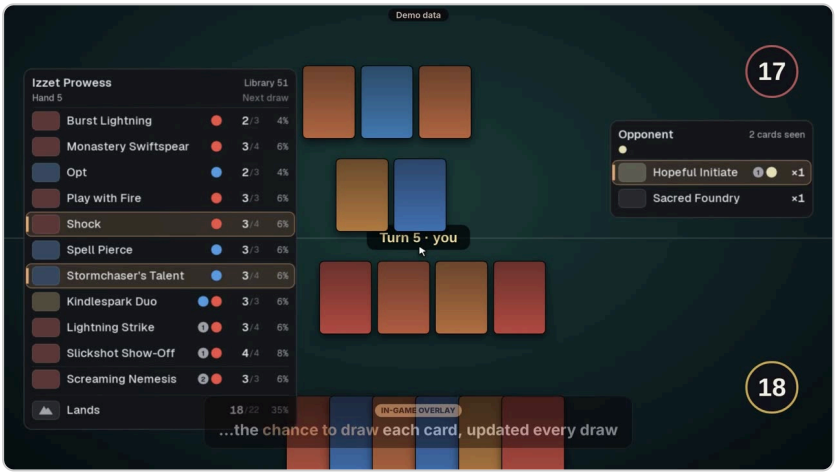


Mistake tags, 30- and 90-day trends and Team mode for the coach. Silent video

Video on the web: https://manalab.es/guia/guia_manalab_en.html#video-coach-tags-trends-team

Settings

- Language: ManaLab is available in 9 languages.
- In-game overlay: shows information while you play.
- Screenshots, and Scryfall lookup when a card is missing.
- Player.log path, if it is not found automatically.
- AI analysis: paste your subscription code here.
- Support on Ko-fi and open the start guide again.
- New version notice: ManaLab tells you when a new version is out and shows you what's new.



In-game overlay: cards left in your deck, the chance to draw each one and the cards your opponent has shown. Silent video

Video on the web: https://manalab.es/guia/guia_manalab_en.html#video-in-game-overlay

Updating ManaLab

From version 2.1.3 on, ManaLab updates itself. When it opens, and once a day, it checks for a new version; if there is one, a notice appears at the bottom left.

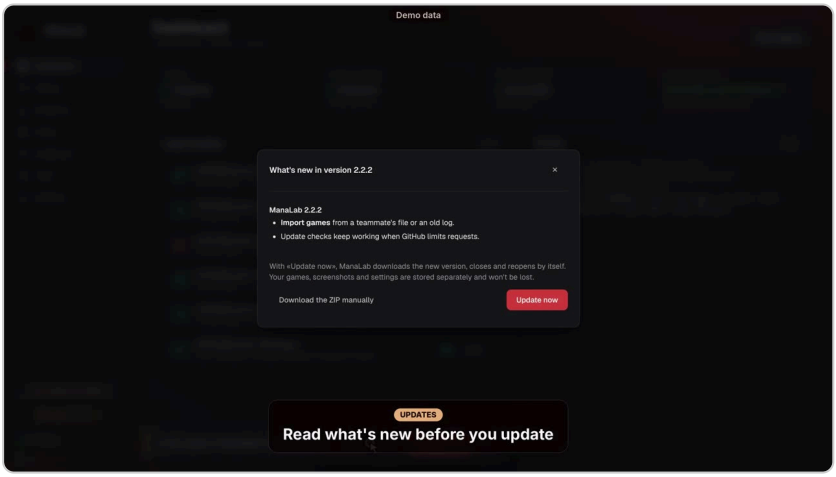
1. In the notice, press «See what's new» if you want to read what it brings.
2. Press «Update now». ManaLab downloads the new version, closes and reopens already updated. The Windows warning doesn't appear.

Your games, screenshots, settings and subscription code are stored separately, in %LOCALAPPDATA%\ManaLab, so they're not lost when updating.

If you're on 2.1.0, 2.1.1 or 2.1.2 (they could start and close without showing the window), update manually one last time: download the ZIP from manalab.es, right-click › Properties › tick «Unblock» › OK, close ManaLab and unzip the ZIP over its folder.

You can check any time in Settings › About › «Check for updates», and turn the notice off with «Let me know when there's a new version».

If you're on version 2.0.1 or earlier, you won't see the notice: download the latest version from manalab.es.



Updating from inside the app: it tells you, shows what's new and, in one click, downloads, verifies and reopens. Silent video

Video on the web: https://manalab.es/guia/guia_manalab_en.html#video-in-app-updates

Privacy

Your data stays on your PC. ManaLab does not read Arena's memory or connect to its servers.

The only thing that leaves your computer is the AI analysis, and only when you ask for it.

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